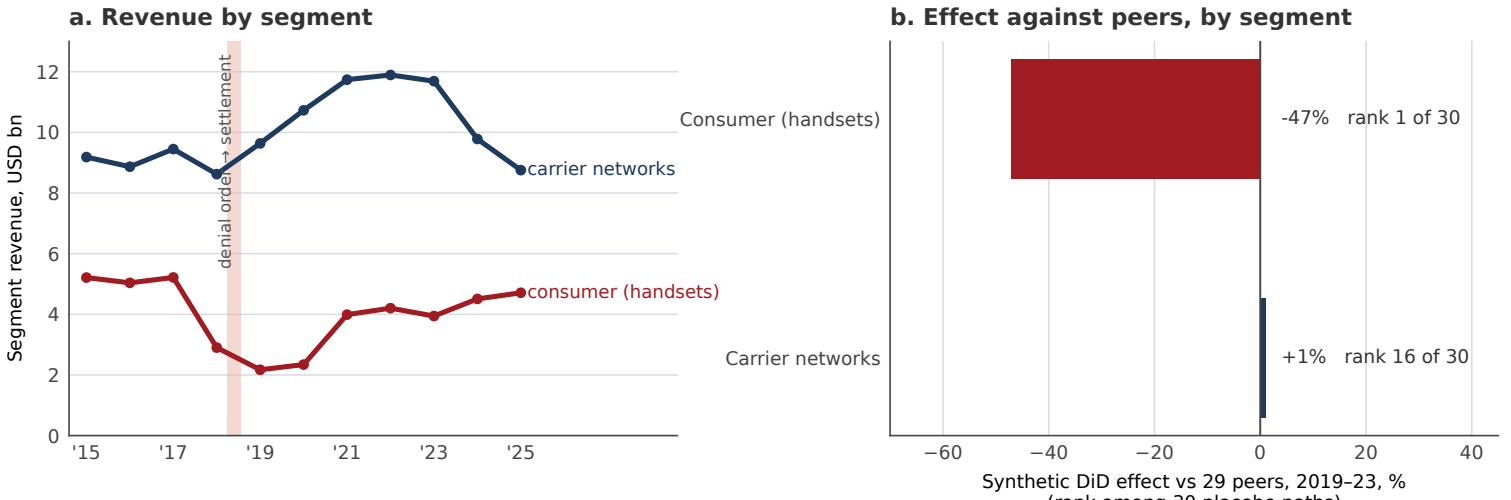
Lifted: the carrier business came back, the handset business did not

ZTE's access was cut in April 2018 and restored in July. Carrier revenue recovered fully against peers; handset revenue fell by nearly half against peers and in level regained only nine-tenths of its 2017 size by 2025. Customers who could switch did not switch back.



Sources: ZTE annual reports (segment revenue, CNY converted at annual average rates; panel telecom_device_panel_logUSD_v2); effects from the clean run of 9 October 2026 (synthetic difference-in-differences against 29 listed peers with complete 2015–2023 data, pre-period 2015–17, post-period 2019–23; rank among the 30 placebo paths).